Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan
Founded By Kulapati (Dr.) K. M. Munshi
Since 1938
DELHI KENDRA

CAMBRIDGE
UNIVERSITY PRESS & ASSESSMENT

Bhavan's Leelawati Munshi College of Education

&

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan College

in association with

Cambridge University Press and Assessment

organises

One Day National Conference

(in Hybrid Mode)

CHARTING THE FUTURE:

Diversity, Equity and Tolerance in a Hyper-connected Transforming World

on 13th March 2026.

Venue: **Munshi Memorial Hall, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, K G Marg, New Delhi.**

Concept Note:

In the entire history of humankind, the present century has been a witness to unprecedented levels of change and complexity, due to technological developments and globalisation. Many of these 'developments' have given rise to alarming rates of inequality, social and economic disparity, heightened levels of dysconciousness, and increased levels of intolerance on ideological, cultural, linguistics and geographical lines. The world already grappling with forms of racism, gender discrimination and exploitation of economically weaker and marginalised sections; is witnessing their magnified forms and proportions, thanks to hyper-connectivity provided by various online medias and channels. There is a felt absence of shared ideals that is making the world deeply fragmented leading to erosion of trust, faith and consequently well-being of individuals, societies and nations. After attaining and sustaining globalisation for some decades, the world is again propelling towards more and more localisation, owing to 'distorted' vision and thinking of some prominent world leaders. Therefore, the world which should be functioning with a shared sense of community, an absence of these ideals is increasingly leading people to retreat into their own silos, increased instances of polarisation and conflicts among various groups. Is this a good for people and communities? Or will continued polarisation is and will lead to overt acts of violence, hate crimes and communal disharmony and in an extreme scenario maybe, extinction of humans and/or environment in the long run.

The world today is seeing increasing instances of intolerance towards the 'other': *other* religion, other nationality, other linguistic background, other race, other ethnicity, other gender, other age and so on so forth. This *othering*, which is basically rooted in negative stereotypes, perceptions and dysconsciousness, is a deeply dehumanising process which leads to social discrimination, exclusion and marginalisation. This dichotomy between 'us' and 'them' is perpetrated by lack of education, personal biases, prejudices, social influences, media influences, generalised beliefs, economic instability, political influences and cultural prejudices primarily. This environment leads to mental separation of people into groups and allows for 'dehumanisation' of the perceived 'other'. When a group becomes 'other' or them, they are 'seen' differently or less worthy and it becomes easier to justify actions that would generally be seen as unjust if they were done to 'us'.

Therefore, in this world defined by breathtaking interconnectivity, the ideals of diversity, equity and tolerance are essential survival guides for humanity. The phrase 'charting the future' indicates and conscious and a deliberate effort on the part of each and every individual, society, community and

nations to move towards a more humane society. In a way the ideals of diversity, equity and tolerance can be seen as three pillars on which the future existence of humanity may depend. The choices we make as an individual, as a society and as a community will shape our global society, which will either be fractured by divisions on multitude of factors or strengthened by a genuine sense of inclusive ideology. The choice is ours, and passive acceptance is no longer an option!

For inculcating this sense of inclusivity, the first step is recognising diversity and then traversing the journey from tolerating diversity to celebrating it. True progress requires a deep commitment to ideals of equity and social justice. In a transforming world, the prevalent systems of power and hegemonies are re-examined through the lens of social justice. The endeavour requires a thorough scholarly examination from multiple angles and disciplines to fully grasp the complexities ranging from deliberating on philosophical, moral and theoretical concerns of fairness, human rights, concept of justice, and the 'why' of inclusive society; understanding the historical roots of slavery, colonialism and other historical injustices; sociological perspectives go beyond social structures, power dynamics, group identities, understanding biases and prejudices from a sociological, psychological and policy framework. The field of Psychology and social psychology can give an understanding of the cognitive processes involved in discrimination and stereotyping and also how to bring about change in the thinking of individuals and of societies collectively. In addition, study of legislature and policy can help us in understanding of aggravating or diminishing discrimination, and also develop meaningful solutions. And to top it all, the hyper-connected nature of our world, driven by technology and social media, is a multiplier force for each and every angle and disciplines. It is like to a double-sided sword, it has the capacity to both accelerate the spread of problems and also to offer new tools and ways to solve them, thus creating a dynamic and an often contradictory environment.

This Conference tries to being together academicians, researchers and practitioners from diverse backgrounds in deliberating on the theme from a multi-directional and multi-disciplinary perspective. The goal is deliberating on moving towards making societies inclusive and open to diverse ideas, people and ideologies. Another important dimension is that of sustainability and environment concerns. Until and unless people and economies all over the world come together, these will continue to be a neglected in a rat race of outdoing one another. This path is not easy, but the tools, though, are within our grasp, the journey involves a conscious resolve on the part of each and every individual to create a world where everyone belongs. This conference hopes to create a platform for having a critical discussion on the theme.

Objectives of the Conference

- To foster critical dialogue on the intersections of diversity, equity, and tolerance across disciplines and industries.
- To deliberate upon multi-pronged approach for addressing social exclusion, systemic bias, and inequality drawing from various fields.
- To showcase transformative research, pedagogies, and practices that promote inclusion in education, policy, literature, management, and technology.
- To promote knowledge exchange between academia, policy, civil society, and industry for creating equitable and inclusive systems.
- To generate policy recommendations and publish scholarly contributions for wider dissemination and impact.

Sub-Themes

1. Humanities & Social Justice

- Reimagining Identity, Culture, and Belonging in Diverse Societies
- Literature as a Medium for Social Change and Equity
- Exploring Dysconsciousness
- Historical Perspectives on Inequality and Resistance Movements
- Philosophy, Ethics, and the Morality of Inclusion

2. Language, Literature, and Communication

- Language and Power: Addressing Bias in Communication
- Multilingualism, Inclusion, and Linguistic Equity
- Literature from the Margins: Voices of the Underrepresented
- Critical Discourse Analysis for Social Equity

3. Commerce, Management & Workplace Inclusion

- Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) in Organizational Culture
- Inclusive Leadership and Ethical Decision Making in Business

- Gender Equity and Representation in Corporate Governance
- Economic Empowerment through Inclusive Entrepreneurship

4. Economics & Public Policy

- Economic Inequality and Social Justice: Bridging the Gap
- Inclusive Growth and Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
- Public Policy Interventions for Marginalized Communities
- Social Protection, Basic Income, and Equity in Economic Systems

5. Education, Pedagogy & Curriculum Design

- Culturally Responsive and Inclusive Teaching Practices
- Addressing Bias and Stereotypes in Curricula
- Equity in Access to Quality Education across Socioeconomic Groups
- Education for Empowerment: Teaching Diversity in the 21st Century

6. Gender, Identity & Intersectionality

- Gender Equity and Intersectional Approaches to Inclusion
- LGBTQ+ Rights, Representation, and Social Acceptance
- Challenging Norms: Identity, Body Politics, and Resistance
- Safe Spaces and Psychological Safety for All

7. Technology, Media, and Digital Inclusion

- Digital Divide: Ensuring Equity in Access and Literacy
- Artificial Intelligence and Algorithmic Bias
- Representation in Media: Diversity in Storytelling
- Ethics of Technology in a Diverse World

8. Globalization and Cross-Cultural Perspectives

- Migration, Diaspora, and Cultural Integration
- Global Citizenship and Intercultural Competency

- Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Inclusive Global Futures
- Comparative Studies in Global DEI Practices

Programme Schedule

9.00 - 10.00am	Registration		
10.00am	*Sarv-Dharma Prarthana*		
Inaugural Session- 13th March 2026 Time:10 am-11.30 am Venue: Munshi Memorial Hall			
10.05-10.10am	Introduction and Felicitation of dignitaries	Dr. Reetu Sharma Dr. Deepak Kumar Adhana	HOD BVBC & Associate Professor, BLMCE Associate Professor, BVBC
10.10-10.20am	Introduction to the Conference	Dr. Geetika Dutta	Dean (Academics), Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Delhi Kendra & Principal, BVBC
10.20-10.25am	Welcome Address	Sh. K Siva Prasad (IAS retd.)	Director, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Delhi Kendra
10.25–10.40am	Keynote Address	Prof. Yukti Sharma	CIE, Dept. of Education, Univ. of Delhi
10.40–10.55am	Special address	Prof Sarfaraz Masood	Dept. of Computer Engineering, Jamia Milia Islamia
10.55-11.10 am	Special address	Ms Sharmistha Ray	Head of HR & Admin, Tech Mahindra Foundation.
11.10-11.25 am	Special address	Ms. Jyoti Khanna	Assistant Vice President, Human Resources, Genpact.
11.25–11.30am	Vote of Thanks	Ms. Meghna Varun	Assistant Professor, BVBC
Tea Break: 11.30-11.45 am			

11.45 am to 1.30 pm	**Technical Session I A** **Venue: Munshi Memorial Hall, BVB** **Chairperson: Prof. Eisha Kanaddi**, English Pedagogy, IGNOU **Keynote Address: Diversity, Inclusion and Cultural Sensitivity in teaching materials: A Publisher's Perspective** **By: Dr Sangeeta Mehta,** Cambridge University Press and Assessment

	Co-chair - Ms. Kriti Songriwal & Dr. Gayathri Paper Presentations: 03 1. Civilisational Ethics as a Framework for Inclusive Futures in a Hyper-Connected World: Dr. Esha 2. Of Character and Culture: Ethics, Leadership, and Diversity in the Workplace: Dr. Shivani Bhatt 3. Literature from the margins: Intersectionality of Identity and the politics of voice in Bama's Karukku: Ms. Shalini Chauhan & Ms. Meghna Varun
11.45 am to 1.30 pm	**Technical Session I B (Online)** **<u>Venue: Room NO 104, Mittal Sadan</u>** **Chairperson: Dr. Shweta Dubey,** Dept. of Home Science**,** Banasthali Vidyapith (Rajasthan) Co-chair - Dr. Poonam & Dr. Indu Paper Presentations: 04 1. To study multilingualism from the perspective of linguistic Equity: Ms. Sarla Devi 2. Gunvattapoorn shiksha tak pahuch mein samta : Aadivasi Mahilaon ki chunautiyan aur sambhavnayen: Ms. Sapna Tirkey 3. एक हाइपर-कनेक्टेड एवं परिवर्तनशील विश्व में विविधता, समानता और सहिष्णुता: शिक्षा, शिक्षण-पद्धति एवं पाठ्यक्रम निर्माण की भूमिका: Ms. Priyanka Singh 4. Teacher Training as a Catalyst for Empowering Diversity in Contemporary Education: Dr. Arti Bhatnagar & Dr. Shalini Bhatnagar
11.45 am to 1.30 pm	**Technical Session I C (Online)** **<u>Venue: ICT Lab 1, Mittal Sadan</u>** **Chairperson: Dr. Ratna Dixit Sharma,** Department of Psychology, Faculty of Social Science, Banasthali Vidyapith (Rajasthan) Co-chair - Dr. Sulekha Ram & Mr. Mashkoor Ilahi Khan Paper Presentations: 05 1. Art Integrated Learning for Inclusive And Democratic Classrooms: Dr. Manvinder Kaur 2. Global Citizenship as a Framework for Intercultural Dialogue in International Relations: Ms. Vaishali Garg 3. Using Technology to Make Cultural Responsiveness: Ways to Cut Down on Bias and Stereotypes in Teacher Training: Mr. Gopal Adhikari 4. Charting the Future: Diversity, Equity and Tolerance in a Hyper-connected Transforming World: Mr. Ando G. 5. Role of Inclusive Growth in Achieving Sustainable Development Goals in India: Dr. Vinod Kumar

11.45 am to 1.30 pm	**Technical Session I D** **<u>Venue: Room No-105, Mittal Sadan</u>** **Chairperson: Prof. Punita Sharma**, Sri Venkateswara College, University of Delhi Co-chair - Dr. Shalini Bhatnagar & Dr. Nisha Paper Presentations: 06 1. The Psychology of Othering in a Hyperconnected World: Literature, Ethics and the Crisis of Dehumanization and Dysconsciousness: Dr. Reetu Sharma, Mr. Dishant Saini & CA Parveen Saini 2. Repositioning Inclusive Global Education: A Comparative Review of Indigenous Knowledge Systems within IB, Cambridge, and NCF 2023: Dr. Meenal, Ms. Prakarti & Ms. Rashi Vats 3. Culturally Responsive Pedagogy in Secondary Mathematics Classrooms: An Empirical Study on Inclusive Teaching Practices and Student Engagement: Ms. Muskan Laique & Dr. Sulekha Ram 4. Echoes of Resistance: A Historical Analysis of Systemic Inequality and the Struggle for Social Justice: Mr. Utkarsh Sharma 5. Reimagining Education: Inclusive Pedagogy, Curriculum Reform, and Equity in 21st Century Classrooms: Ms. Muskan Mishra, Ms. Pooja Roy & Dr. Pooja Tomar 6. Understanding Caste in Hyperconnected Digital Spaces: Visibility, Voice and Digital Exclusion: Ms. Aadya and Dr. Shivani Bhatt
1.30 pm to 2.15pm	**LUNCH**
2.15 pm to 4.00 pm	**Technical Session II A** **<u>Venue: Munshi Memorial Hall, BVB</u>** **Chairperson: Dr Amit Sharma**, Associate Prof, School of Management, GGSIPU Co-chair - Dr. Shalini Gupta & Ms. Akanksha Garg Paper Presentations: 06 1. Between Constitutional Promise and Social Reality: Sexual Citizenship and LGBTQ+ Inclusion in India: Mr. Mashkoor Ilahi Khan 2. Education for Empowerment: Teaching Diversity in the 21st Century: Rahul Mallick and Dr. Reetu Sharma 3. Gender Equity and Intersectional Approaches to Inclusion: Ms. Prakriti Verma & Mr. Mashkoor Ilahi Khan 4. Fostering Inclusive Learning Environments Through Culturally Responsive Pedagogy: Ms. Shweta Ghosh and Dr. Pooja Tomar 5. From Text to Play: Teaching Symbolism through Video Games as a Pedagogical Tool in Literature Classrooms: Mr. Mannu Kaushal 6. From Marginalization to Mainstreaming: Representation of Transgender People in Indian Media: Ms. Megha Aggarwal

2.15 pm to 4.00 pm	**Technical Session II B** **<u>Venue: 105, Mittal Sadan</u>** **Chairperson: Dr. Neha**, Associate Prof, Maitreyi College, University of Delhi Co-chair - Dr. Deepak Kumar Adhana & Dr. Nancy Paper Presentations: 06 1. Inclusion as a Catalyst for diversity to engagement: Dr. Sugandh Rawal & Ms. Shivani Sharma 2. A Decade of Digital Revolution in India: Expanding Global Footprints and International Impact: Ms. Upasana Chadha & Dr. Deepak Adhana 3. Government Initiatives for Economic Empowerment through Inclusive Entrepreneurship: Impact on Women Entrepreneurs: Ms. Pooja Khanna 4. Economic Empowerment through Inclusive Entrepreneurship: Insights from the Delhi–NCR Region: Mr. Raj Karan 5. Climate-Related Disclosures under IFRS: Opportunities and Challenges faced by Automobile Sector in India: Dr. Sneha Verma & Ms. Dhriti Sawhney 6. Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion in Organizational Culture: Examining Real-World Implementation and Its Impact on Employee Job Satisfaction: Ms. Khushbu and Dr.Poonam Sharma
2.15 pm to 4.00 pm	**Technical Session II C (Online)** **<u>Venue: ICT Lab</u>** **Chairperson: Dr. Nutan Bharti,** Researcher & Practitioner, Countrywide Research (CWCR), Connnected Learnng Initiatives (CLIX), MIT Boston, TISS Mumbai, HWPL , CoL-CEMCA. Co-chair: Dr. Esha & Dr. Chandra Shekhar Paper Presentations: 04 1. Digital Divide 2.0: Algorithmic Governance, Educational Inequality, and the Quest for Justice by Ms. Annu 2. Algorithmic Bias in Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Digital Inclusion by Dr. Mitramani Singh 3. Embedding Cultural Intelligence into Artificial Intelligence: An Ethical Framework for Globally Responsible AI Deployment by Mr. Vansh Jain 4. Artificial Intelligence in Science Education: Opportunities, Challenges, and Ethical Implications Inclusive Pedagogy by Ms. Nitika Bisht & Dr. Shalini Gupta 5. Bridging Economic inequality and social justice: Pathways towards an equitable society by Ms. Kashvi Kaushik & Dr. Shalini Bhatnagar.

VALEDICTORY SESSION- 4.00 pm. to 5.15 pm (Venue: Munshi Memorial Hall, Mittal Sadan)			
4.05-4.15pm	Introduction and Felicitation of Dignitaries	Dr. Deepak Kumar Adhana	Associate Professor, BVBC
4.15-4.25pm	**Welcome Address**	**Sh. K Siva Prasad (IAS Retd.)**	**Director, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Delhi Kendra, Retd. IAS**
4.25-4.35pm	Presentation of Conference Report	Dr. Reetu Sharma	HOD BVBC & Associate Professor, BLMCE
4.35-5.00pm	**Valedictory Address**	**Chief Guest: Prof. Namita Ranganathan**	**Former Head & Dean, CIE, Dept. of Education, Univ. of Delhi**
5.00-5.15pm	Vote of Thanks	Dr. Geetika Datta	Dean (Academics), Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Delhi Kendra & Principal, BVBC
5.15 pm	**NATIONAL ANTHEM**		